

Holehe Installation & Usage Guide

Windows setup walkthrough — installation through execution

1. Prerequisites

Holehe is a Python-based command-line OSINT tool used to check whether an email address is registered on various websites. It works on Windows, macOS, and Linux.

Recommended: Python 3.7 to 3.11. Python 3.13 is very new and can cause dependency issues, since some packages may not yet have full compatibility with it.

Check your Python version:

```
python --version
```

Upgrade pip before installing anything:

```
python -m pip install --upgrade pip
```

2. Install Holehe

The simplest method is installing directly from PyPI. This does not require cloning the GitHub repository.

```
pip install holehe
```

Alternative — installing from source (GitHub repo), if you need the latest unreleased code or want to modify it:

```
cd C:\Desktop\holehe-master\holehe-master python -m pip install setuptools python -m pip install .
```

3. Dependencies to Install Explicitly

Even though `pip install holehe` should pull in all required dependencies automatically, in practice some environments (especially newer Python versions) skip or silently fail on a few of them. Installing these explicitly avoids the most common `ModuleNotFoundError` issues:

```
pip install requests httpx trio bs4 setuptools
```

Package	Why Holehe Needs It
requests	Used by several site-check modules (e.g. facebook.py)
httpx	Core async HTTP client holehe uses to query sites
trio	Async runtime that holehe's core execution is built on
bs4 (BeautifulSoup)	HTML parsing for some site modules
setuptools	Only needed if installing via setup.py instead of pip

4. Verify Installation

Confirm holehe installed correctly:

```
holehe --help
```

If this prints the usage/options screen, the installation succeeded.

5. If the Command Isn't Recognized

If Windows says holehe is not recognized as a command, it usually means Python's Scripts folder isn't in your PATH. Run holehe as a module instead — this sidesteps the PATH issue entirely:

```
python -m holehe someone@gmail.com
```

6. Running Holehe

Basic scan:

```
holehe someone@gmail.com
```

Only show sites where the email is actually registered:

```
holehe someone@gmail.com --only-used
```

Save results to a CSV file:

```
holehe someone@gmail.com --only-used -C
```

Skip password-recovery checks (faster, less intrusive):

```
holehe someone@gmail.com -NP
```

Set a custom timeout (default is 10 seconds):

```
holehe someone@gmail.com -T 15
```

7. Command-Line Flags Reference

Flag	Description
-h, --help	Show help message and exit
--only-used	Display only the sites used by the target email
--no-color	Don't color terminal output
--no-clear	Do not clear the terminal to display results

-NP, --no-password-recovery	Do not try password recovery on websites
-C, --csv	Create a CSV file with the results
-T, --timeout	Set max timeout value (default 10 seconds)

8. Troubleshooting Checklist

- ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'X' → run `pip install X` and retry
- Command not recognized → use `python -m holehe ...` instead
- Repeated dependency errors → consider a clean virtual environment on Python 3.10 or 3.11

Recommended Virtual Environment Setup

```
python -m venv venv venv\Scripts\activate pip install holehe requests httpx trio bs4
```

This guide reflects a working install-to-execution path verified during setup, including all dependency errors encountered along the way and how each was resolved.